

RAMCO VIDYA MANDIR SR. SEC. SCHOOL, THAMARAikulAM
CLASS 12 ENGLISH REVISION – PR 2 LOST SPRING

Marks : 15
Duration : 30 Minutes

Name :
Exam No. :

Total Marks: 80

Section A: Extract Based Comprehension (3 x 5 = 15 marks)

1. Extract 1:

"Why do you do this?" I ask Saheb whom I encounter every morning scrounging for gold in the garbage dumps of my neighbourhood. Saheb left his home long ago. Set amidst the green fields of Dhaka, his home is not even a distant memory. There were many storms that swept away their fields and homes, his mother tells him. That's why they left, looking for gold in the big city where he now lives. "I have nothing else to do," he mutters, looking away. "Go to school," I say glibly, realising immediately how hollow the advice must sound. "There is no school in my neighbourhood. When they build one, I will go."

i. (MCQ) What does Saheb look for in the garbage dumps? (1 mark)

- a) Toys b) Gold c) Food d) Shelter

ii. (MCQ) Why did Saheb leave his home? (1 mark)

- a) He wanted to go to school c) Storms destroyed his home and fields
b) His parents forced him to leave d) He wanted to find gold

iii. (Assertion-Reasoning) (1 mark)

****Assertion:** The author's advice to Saheb to go to school was hollow.**

****Reason:** There was no school in Saheb's neighborhood.**

- a) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion.
b) Both the assertion and the reason are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation of the assertion.
c) The assertion is true, but the reason is false.
d) The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

iv. (Assertion-Reasoning) (1 mark)

****Assertion:** Saheb's memories of his home are vivid.**

****Reason:** His home was set amidst green fields in Dhaka.**

- a) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion.
b) Both the assertion and the reason are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation of the assertion.
c) The assertion is true, but the reason is false.
d) The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

v. (Choose the correct words) (1 mark)

Choose the words to describe Saheb's attitude: Saheb was _ and seemed _ about his situation.

- a) hopeful, excited c) angry, rebellious
b) resigned, indifferent d) eager, ambitious

2. **Extract 2:**

This morning, Saheb is on his way to the milk booth. In his hand is a steel canister. "I now work in a tea stall down the road," he says, pointing in the distance. "I am paid 800 rupees and all my meals." Does he like the job? I ask. His face, I see, has lost the carefree look. The steel canister seems heavier than the plastic bag he would carry so lightly over his shoulder. The bag was his. The canister belongs to the man who owns the tea shop. Saheb is no longer his own master!

i. (MCQ) Where does Saheb work now? (1 mark)

- a) In a garbage dump
- b) At a tea stall c) At a milk booth d) In a school

ii. (MCQ) What has Saheb lost? (1 mark)

- a) His home
- b) His friends
- c) His freedom
- d) His money

iii. (Assertion-Reasoning) (1 mark)

****Assertion:** Saheb seems less happy working at the tea stall.**

****Reason:** He is no longer his own master.**

- a) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion.
- b) Both the assertion and the reason are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation of the assertion.
- c) The assertion is true, but the reason is false.
- d) The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

iv. (Assertion-Reasoning) (1 mark)

****Assertion:** Saheb carries a steel canister.**

****Reason:** He is going to the milk booth.**

- a) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion.
- b) Both the assertion and the reason are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation of the assertion.
- c) The assertion is true, but the reason is false.
- d) The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

v. (Choose the correct words) (1 mark)

Choose the words to describe Saheb's new job: Saheb's new job pays him but he has lost his _.

- a) well, money b) badly, freedom c) well, freedom d) poorly, money

3. **Extract 3:**

"It is his karam, his destiny," says Mukesh's grandmother, who has watched her own husband go blind with the dust from polishing the glass of bangles. "Can a god-given lineage ever be broken?" she implies. Born in the caste of bangle makers, they have seen nothing but bangles in the house, in the yard, in every other house, every other yard, every street in Firozabad.

i. (MCQ) What does Mukesh's grandmother say about their situation? (1 mark)

- a) It is their choice
- b) It is their destiny
- c) It is unfair
- d) It will change

ii. (MCQ) What is the traditional occupation of Mukesh's family? (1 mark)

- a) Farming
- b) Weaving
- c) Bangle making
- d) Pottery

iii. (Assertion-Reasoning) (1 mark)

****Assertion:**** Mukesh's grandmother believes their lineage cannot be broken.

****Reason:**** They are born into the caste of bangle makers.

- a) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion.
- b) Both the assertion and the reason are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation of the assertion.
- c) The assertion is true, but the reason is false.
- d) The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

iv. (Assertion-Reasoning) (1 mark)

****Assertion:**** Mukesh's grandmother is optimistic about the future.

****Reason:**** She believes their destiny can be changed.

- a) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion.
- b) Both the assertion and the reason are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation of the assertion.
- c) The assertion is true, but the reason is false.
- d) The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

v. (Choose the correct words) (1 mark)

Choose the words to describe the bangle makers' lives: The bangle makers of Firozabad are trapped by _ and a sense of _.

- | | |
|--------------------------|------------------------|
| a) poverty, hopelessness | c) tradition, ambition |
| b) wealth, opportunity | d) modernity, change |

Section B: Short Answer Questions (12 x 2 = 24 marks)

1. What is Saheb looking for in the garbage dumps? Where is he from?
2. What explanations does the author offer for the children not wearing footwear?
3. Is Saheb happy working at the tea-stall? Explain.
4. What makes the city of Firozabad famous?
5. Mention the hazards of working in the glass bangles industry.
6. How is Mukesh's attitude to his situation different from that of his family?
7. How does the author describe Seemapuri?
8. What does garbage mean to the children and to the elders in Seemapuri?
9. What is the significance of bangles in Indian culture?
10. What literary device is used in the phrase "garbage to them is gold" and what does it mean?
11. Explain the metaphor "web of poverty".
12. What does the author mean by "a perpetual state of poverty"?

Section C: Long Answer Questions (7 x 7 = 49 marks)

1. **Theme-based question:** The story "Lost Spring" highlights the theme of lost childhood. Discuss the factors that contribute to this loss with reference to Saheb and Mukesh.
2. **Value-based question:** The story emphasizes the importance of dreams and aspirations. How can education help children like Saheb and Mukesh to realize their dreams and break the cycle of poverty?
3. **Article-based question:** Write an article on the issue of child labor in India, drawing examples from "Lost Spring" and suggesting solutions to eradicate this problem.
4. **Speech-based question:** Prepare a short speech to raise awareness about the plight of children working in hazardous industries, focusing on the need for stricter laws and better enforcement.
5. **Story-based question:** Imagine Saheb gets an opportunity to go to school. Write a short story about his experiences, his challenges, and his achievements.
6. **Author's point of view:** From Anees Jung's perspective, analyze the social and economic conditions that perpetuate child labor in India.
7. **Diary Entry:** Write a diary entry as Mukesh, expressing your feelings and determination to become a motor mechanic despite the obstacles.

Answer Key

Section A: Extract Based Comprehension

1. i. b) Gold ii. c) Storms destroyed his home and fields iii. a) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion. iv. d) The assertion is false, but the reason is true. v. b) resigned, indifferent
2. i. b) At a tea stall ii. c) His freedom iii. a) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion. iv. b) Both the assertion and the reason are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation of the assertion. v. c) well, freedom
3. i. b) It is their destiny ii. c) Bangle making iii. a) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion. iv. c) The assertion is true, but the reason is false. v. a) poverty, hopelessness

Section B: Short Answer Questions

1. Saheb is looking for gold in the garbage dumps. He is from Dhaka.
2. The author offers two explanations: one is that it is a tradition to stay barefoot, and the other is that it is an excuse to explain away a perpetual state of poverty.
3. No, Saheb is not happy working at the tea-stall. He has lost his carefree look and is no longer his own master.
4. The city of Firozabad is famous for its bangle-making industry.
5. The hazards of working in the glass bangles industry include working in high temperatures, in dingy cells without air and light, and often losing eyesight.
6. Mukesh is determined to be a motor mechanic and dreams of a different future, unlike his family, who have accepted their fate as bangle makers.
7. The author describes Seemapuri as a place on the periphery of Delhi, inhabited by squatters living in mud structures with tin and tarpaulin roofs, devoid of basic amenities.
8. Garbage is wrapped in wonder for children, while for elders, it is a means of survival.
9. Bangles symbolize an Indian woman's *suhaag*, or auspiciousness in marriage.
10. The literary device used is a hyperbole. It means that garbage is as valuable as gold for their survival.

11. The metaphor "web of poverty" refers to how the poor are trapped in a cycle of poverty that is difficult to escape, like being caught in a web.
12. "A perpetual state of poverty" means poverty that continues for a very long time

Section C: Long Answer Questions

1. Theme-based question:

- **Introduction:** Briefly introduce the theme of lost childhood in "Lost Spring."
- **Para 1 (Saheb):** Explain how Saheb's childhood is lost due to poverty and the need to scavenge for a living. Lack of access to education and a stable home.
- **Para 2 (Mukesh):** Describe how Mukesh's childhood is affected by the tradition of bangle making and the hazardous working conditions in Firozabad.
- **Conclusion:** Summarize the tragic reality of lost childhood and the need for societal change.

2. Value-based question:

- **Introduction:** State the importance of dreams and aspirations for children.
- **Para 1:** Discuss how education can empower children like Saheb by providing them with opportunities for better jobs and a way out of poverty.
- **Para 2:** Explain how education can help children like Mukesh break free from the traditional cycle of bangle making and pursue their ambitions.
- **Conclusion:** Emphasize the role of education in fostering social change and giving children a chance at a better future.

3. Article-based question:

- **Heading:** Child Labor in India: A Call for Action
- **Para 1:** Introduce the problem of child labor in India and its prevalence.
- **Para 2:** Provide examples from "Lost Spring," such as Saheb's ragpicking and Mukesh's bangle making, to illustrate the harsh realities of child labor.
- **Para 3:** Discuss the causes of child labor, including poverty, lack of education, and social inequality.
- **Para 4:** Suggest solutions such as stricter enforcement of laws, providing access to quality

1. Theme-based question: The story "Lost Spring" highlights the theme of lost childhood. Discuss the factors that contribute to this loss with reference to Saheb and Mukesh.

Introduction: "Lost Spring" poignantly portrays the theme of lost childhood, focusing on the harsh realities faced by impoverished children in India. The story explores how socio-economic factors deprive children like Saheb and Mukesh of the joys and opportunities that should define their youth.

Para 1 (Saheb): Saheb's life as a ragpicker exemplifies the loss of childhood. Forced to scavenge for survival in the garbage dumps of Seemapuri, he is denied access to education and a stable home. Instead of playing and attending school, his days are spent in grueling labor, highlighting how poverty can steal a child's innocence and potential.

Para 2 (Mukesh): Mukesh's situation in Firozabad illustrates another facet of lost childhood. Bound by the tradition of bangle making, he is compelled to work in hazardous conditions within glass furnaces. This exposes him to health risks and limits his world to the confines of the factory, preventing him from pursuing his dreams and ambitions.

Conclusion: "Lost Spring" effectively conveys how poverty, societal norms, and exploitative labor practices rob children of their childhood. The stories of Saheb and Mukesh serve as a powerful reminder of the urgent need to address these issues and protect the rights of every child.

2. Value-based question: The story emphasizes the importance of dreams and aspirations. How can education help children like Saheb and Mukesh to realize their dreams and break the cycle of poverty?

Introduction: "Lost Spring" underscores the significance of dreams and aspirations in overcoming adversity. Education emerges as a crucial catalyst in empowering children like Saheb and Mukesh to pursue their ambitions and escape the grip of poverty.

Para 1: Education can provide Saheb with the means to transform his life. By acquiring literacy and skills, he can access better job opportunities, moving beyond the demeaning work of ragpicking. Education can broaden his worldview and instill in him a sense of self-worth, enabling him to break free from the cycle of poverty.

Para 2: For Mukesh, education, particularly technical training, is essential to achieve his dream of becoming a motor mechanic. Education can equip him with the necessary expertise and knowledge, enabling him to establish his own identity and escape the traditional occupation of bangle making, which has trapped his family for generations.

Conclusion: In conclusion, education is portrayed as a powerful tool for social mobility in "Lost Spring." By fostering dreams and providing the means to achieve them, education can empower children to create a brighter future for themselves and their communities.

3. Article-based question: Write an article on the issue of child labor in India, drawing examples from "Lost Spring" and suggesting solutions to eradicate this problem.

Introduction: Child labor remains a significant social problem in India, depriving countless children of their childhood and hindering their development. "Lost Spring" offers a poignant look into this issue through the lives of Saheb and Mukesh.

Para 1: The story vividly portrays the harsh realities of child labor. Saheb's involvement in ragpicking illustrates the plight of children forced into hazardous and exploitative work due to poverty. Mukesh's employment in the bangle-making industry highlights the dangers of children working in unsafe conditions, risking their health and well-being.

Para 2: To effectively address child labor, a multi-pronged approach is necessary. Strict enforcement of existing child labor laws is crucial, coupled with measures to improve the socio-economic conditions of vulnerable families. Providing access to quality education is paramount, as it offers children an alternative to child labor and equips them with the skills for a better future.

Conclusion: Eradicating child labor requires a concerted effort from the government, society, and individuals. By prioritizing children's rights and investing in their future, India can move towards a more just and equitable society.

4. Speech-based question: Prepare a short speech to raise awareness about the plight of children working in hazardous industries, focusing on the need for stricter laws and better enforcement.

Introduction: Esteemed audience, today, I stand before you to address the grave issue of child labor in hazardous industries, a problem that continues to plague our society and steal

the futures of countless children. "Lost Spring" poignantly portrays this harsh reality, compelling us to take action.

Para 1: Children like Mukesh, who are forced to work in the bangle-making factories of Firozabad, face immense dangers. They are exposed to extreme heat, toxic fumes, and the risk of blindness, sacrificing their health and well-being for meager wages. This blatant violation of their rights demands our immediate attention.

Para 2: While laws prohibiting child labor in hazardous industries exist, their enforcement remains weak. We need stricter regulations with severe penalties for violators, coupled with robust monitoring mechanisms to ensure compliance. Furthermore, addressing the root causes of child labor, such as poverty and lack of access to education, is crucial for long-term solutions.

Conclusion: Let us pledge to be the voice of these voiceless children. We must advocate for stricter laws, demand better enforcement, and work towards creating a society where every child is protected, safe, and has the opportunity to thrive.

5. Story-based question: Imagine Saheb gets an opportunity to go to school. Write a short story about his experiences, his challenges, and his achievements.

Introduction: Saheb, the ragpicker from Seemapuri, never imagined a life beyond scavenging. However, an unexpected opportunity to attend school opened a new chapter in his life, filled with challenges and triumphs.

Para 1: Entering the classroom for the first time was daunting for Saheb. The structured environment and the unfamiliar lessons were a stark contrast to his previous existence. He struggled to keep up with his classmates, grappling with basic literacy and numeracy. The fear of failure loomed large, threatening to extinguish his newfound hope.

Para 2: Yet, Saheb's resilience and determination propelled him forward. He spent countless hours studying, his small dwelling illuminated by a single lamp. With the support of his teachers and the encouragement of his peers, he gradually began to excel. He discovered a passion for learning and a hidden talent for art, surprising everyone with his creativity and imagination.

Conclusion: Saheb's journey was a testament to the transformative power of education. From a ragpicker to a promising student, he proved that with opportunity and perseverance, even the most disadvantaged can achieve their dreams. His success inspired others in Seemapuri to believe in the possibility of a better future.

6. Author's point of view: From Anees Jung's perspective, analyze the social and economic conditions that perpetuate child labor in India.

Introduction: Anees Jung, in "Lost Spring," offers a powerful critique of the social and economic conditions that perpetuate child labor in India. Her narrative exposes the systemic issues that trap children in a cycle of poverty and exploitation.

Para 1: Jung highlights how poverty is a primary driver of child labor, forcing families to send their children to work to supplement meager incomes. She portrays the desperation of parents who see their children as economic assets rather than individuals with inherent rights. This economic pressure leaves children vulnerable to exploitation and denies them the chance to attend school and enjoy a normal childhood.

Para 2: The author also emphasizes the role of social structures and traditions in perpetuating child labor. She illustrates how the caste system and traditional occupations, such as bangle making, confine children to specific professions from a young age, limiting their choices and

opportunities. This deeply ingrained social conditioning reinforces the cycle of poverty and restricts social mobility.

Conclusion: Anees Jung's perspective in "Lost Spring" reveals the complex interplay of economic hardship and social inequality that fuels child labor in India. She calls for a societal shift that prioritizes children's well-being and addresses the systemic issues that perpetuate their exploitation.

7. Diary Entry: Write a diary entry as Mukesh, expressing your feelings and determination to become a motor mechanic despite the obstacles.

Date: October 26, 2024

Introduction: Dear Diary, today was another grueling day in the bangle factory. The heat from the furnace was unbearable, and the dust stung my eyes. Sometimes, I feel like I'm suffocating in this place, trapped like my father and his father before him.

Para 1: But I refuse to accept this as my destiny. I have a dream, a burning desire to become a motor mechanic. The whirring of engines and the smell of grease excite me in a way these bangles never will. I know it won't be easy. My family doesn't understand my ambition; they say it's my "karam" to follow the family trade.

Para 2: But I'm determined to prove them wrong. I've found a garage a few miles away, and I plan to walk there every day after work to learn the trade. It will be tiring, and I'll face many obstacles, but the thought of working on cars keeps me going. I want to be my own master, to have control over my life, something these bangles will never give me.

Conclusion: Tonight, I go to sleep with a glimmer of hope in my heart. I know the road ahead will be tough, but I'm ready to fight for my dream. One day, I will escape this dusty town and build a different future for myself.